



**BALL STATE**  
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# **Module 13 Lecture - F Distribution and One-Way ANOVA**

Introduction to Statistical Methods

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# 1 Overview and Introduction

## 1.1 Textbook Learning Objectives

- Interpret the F probability distribution as the number of groups and the sample size change.
- Discuss one use for the F distribution: one-way ANOVA
- Conduct and interpret one-way ANOVA.

## 1.2 Instructor Learning Objectives

- Appreciate the ANOVA as another test in your toolbox alongside the other tests for dealing with categorical and continuous outcome variables
- Understand the F-distribution as another practical distribution for deriving inferences and conclusions

## 1.3 Introduction

 Discuss: When we needed to compare the averages of two groups on a continuous variable, what statistical test would we use?

- While we've already covered how to test \_\_\_\_\_ between two groups, now we need to consider the scenario with \_\_\_\_\_ or more groups on some outcome
  - Examples:
    - \* Comparing class outcomes for those in hybrid, in-person, or online sections
    - \* Comparing students on three different tracks in high school: regular, advanced, or remedial
- When we are comparing three \_\_\_\_\_ groups on some numeric, \_\_\_\_\_ outcome, we will employ the one-way ANOVA, standing for **Analysis of Variance (ANOVA)**
  - ANOVA is a \_\_\_\_\_ family of techniques with many applications and extensions

- We are looking at the one-way ANOVA as a \_\_\_\_\_ use of this technique

### ! Important

This is very similar to how we introduced simple linear regression - there are many more advancements on top of what you learn in this class, which you will encounter in more advanced statistics classes!

- Why not use a bunch of \_\_\_\_\_ across the 3 groups instead of this new complicated method?
  - Problem: It raises our Type I error rate
  - This is something done as part of ANOVA in \_\_\_\_\_ testing, but that won't be covered here

### 🗨 Discuss: Describe what Type I errors are

- Our previous tests all made use of specific, practical \_\_\_\_\_ for determining significance:
  - z-tests → normal distribution
  - t-tests → t-distribution
  - $\chi^2$  tests →  $\chi^2$  distribution
  - The ANOVA family will introduce a new distribution: the \_\_\_\_\_
- We'll start by describing the F-distribution itself, then the F-ratio/statistic that we compute, and then finally the application within the One-way ANOVA

## 2 The F Distribution

### 2.1 Introduction

- The **F-distribution** was developed by Sir Ronald Fisher and is a unique distribution applied often for the \_\_\_\_\_ family of statistical tests
  - In \_\_\_\_\_ it is given as  $F \sim F_{df(num), df(denom)}$  where:
    - $df(num) \rightarrow df_{between}$  and  $df(denom) \rightarrow df_{within}$
    - Example:  $F \sim F_{2,24}$  has:

$$\begin{aligned} * df_{between} &= 2 \\ * df_{within} &= 24 \end{aligned}$$

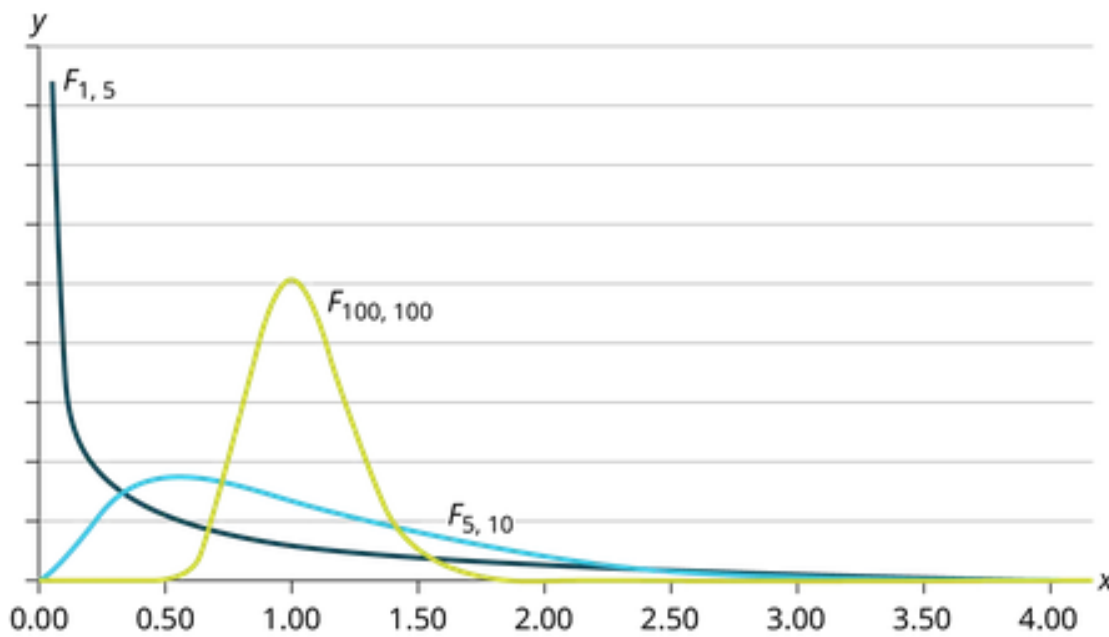
**! Important**

Hold on just a second, \*two\* different degrees of freedom? Yes! We'll discuss more about why that is in our discussion on the F-ratio itself

- The F-distribution actually consists of values that are squares of the t-distribution, and is derived from the t-distribution
  - How exactly Fisher proved that is way beyond the scope of this class

🔊 Discuss: Recall, what exactly is the distinction that makes the t-distribution different and useful over the normal distribution? The F-statistic benefits from this the same!

## 2.2 Additional Facts About the F Distribution



- The curve is not                      but skewed to the right.

- Thus, it has a more similar look to the \_\_\_\_\_ distribution, compared to the t-distribution
- There is a different curve for each set of \_\_\_\_\_.
  - Once again, similar to chi-squared
- The F statistic is greater than or equal to zero.

 Discuss: After you work through the F-ratio section and calculation below, return to this section and try to explain, using the formula, why this F is always greater than or equal to zero

- As the degrees of freedom for the numerator and for the denominator get larger, the curve approximates the \_\_\_\_\_ distribution.
  - Remember, the  $df_{between} \rightarrow$  numerator and the  $df_{within} \rightarrow$  denominator

## 3 The F Ratio

### 3.1 Introduction

- The **F-ratio** is just another name for the F statistic that \_\_\_\_\_ from the test we run
  - The F-ratio/statistic we get is a ratio of:
    - \* The variances \_\_\_\_\_ samples
    - \* The variances \_\_\_\_\_ samples
    - \* It's formula is given as:

$$F = \frac{MS_{between}}{MS_{within}}$$

- We'll describe what the  $MS$  means here in a second

## 3.2 Between & Within Variation

- For **Variances between samples**, we are considering how much \_\_\_\_\_ there is between the 3 or more groups we are comparing to one another
  - This may also be known as “variation due to \_\_\_\_\_” or “\_\_\_\_\_ variation”
  - This will be represented \_\_\_\_\_ as the  $MS_{between}$  or the **mean square**
  - This is the \_\_\_\_\_ of the F-ratio formula
- In the case of **Variances within samples**, we examine how much variation there is within \_\_\_\_\_ of the groups we are comparing to one another
  - This may also be known as “variation due to \_\_\_\_\_” or “\_\_\_\_\_ variation”
  - This will be represented as  $MS_{within}$  in the following formula
  - This is the \_\_\_\_\_ of the F-ratio formula

## 3.3 Calculation of the F-ratio/statistic

- We are *not* going to calculate F by hand, as it is very time-consuming, albeit plenty possible
  - However, you should still follow along and make sure you can see the flow of information as we substitute numbers in these calculations

### 3.3.1 Overall F Calculation

$$F = \frac{MS_{between}}{MS_{within}}$$

### 3.3.2 Between-group Calculations

$$MS_{between} = \frac{SS_{between}}{df_{between}}$$

$$df_{between} = k - 1$$

$$SS_{between} = \sum \left[ \frac{(s_j)^2}{n_j} \right] - \frac{(\sum s_j)^2}{n}$$

$$SS_{total} = \sum x^2 \cdot \frac{(\sum x)^2}{n}$$

• Where

- $SS_{between}$  : Sum of squares between groups
- $SS_{total}$  : Sum of squares total
- $df_{between}$  : degrees of freedom between groups
- $k$  : the number of groups
- $n$  : total sample size
- $n_j$  : the size of  $j^{th}$  group
- $s_j$  : sum of values of  $j^{th}$  group

### 3.3.3 Within-group Calculations

$$MS_{within} = \frac{SS_{within}}{df_{within}}$$

$$df_{within} = n - k$$

$$SS_{within} = SS_{total} - SS_{between}$$

• Where

- $SS_{within}$  : Sum of squares within groups
- $SS_{between}$  : Sum of squares between groups
- $SS_{total}$  : Sum of squares total
- $df_{within}$  : degrees of freedom within groups
- $n$  : total sample size

### 3.4 Conclusions with the F-ratio/statistic

 Discuss: Review: describe the general processes of hypothesis testing, starting with setting the null and alternative hypotheses and ending with a rejection or retaining of the null hypothesis. Try and use the words 'rare event' at some point in your explanation.

- The F statistic, which we derive from the formula for whatever test we are using, is actually best described as a \_\_\_\_\_ or fraction (we'll return to this ratio/statistic in a bit!)
  - Much like previous test statistics, we use this to determine if our results are \_\_\_\_\_ enough to describe our results as unlikely if the null hypothesis is \_\_\_\_\_
  - As usual, the F statistic has a corresponding \_\_\_\_\_ that tell us the probability of results due to chance under the null hypothesis

 What value do we compare p against to determine if we can reject the null hypothesis?

- ☒ A) Alpha  
☐ B) Omega  
☐ C) Confidence Level  
☐ D) Beta

Explanation:

- For \_\_\_\_\_ testing of the F-ratio, our one-way ANOVA test will always be \_\_\_\_\_-tailed due to the ratio nature of statistic, with larger numbers suggest greater variation between groups relative to the variation within groups!
  - Put another way, we are trying to see if it is \_\_\_\_\_ enough out on the right tail to say that it is significant!

 Discuss: Which other distribution also always had a right-tailed application? Explain why that is using the relevant formula for that statistic.

## 4 One-way ANOVA

### 4.1 Introduction

#### Important

In the prior calculations, we covered the mathematical computation in a one-way ANOVA, but this next part will cover the more conceptual side of things.

- The goal of the one-way ANOVA is to determine if there are \_\_\_\_\_ differences between \_\_\_\_\_ group means
  - This is done by examining the \_\_\_\_\_ of the groups (as we previously discussed as part of The F Ratio)
- This is how we will practically use the F-distribution

### 4.2 Assumptions

- Much like the other tests, we need to be mindful of several \_\_\_\_\_ that underlie this statistical test
- These assumptions are:
  - Each population from which a sample is taken is assumed to be \_\_\_\_\_.
  - All samples are \_\_\_\_\_ selected and independent.
  - The populations are assumed to have \_\_\_\_\_ standard deviations (or variances).
  - The factor is a \_\_\_\_\_ variable.

- The response is a \_\_\_\_\_ variable.

### 4.3 Null and Alternative Hypotheses

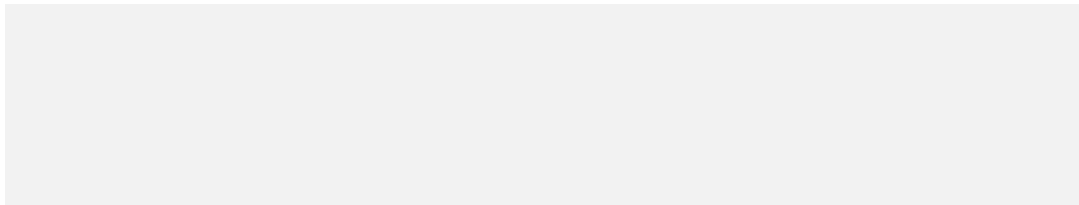
- In a one-way ANOVA, the \_\_\_\_\_ hypothesis is as follows:
  - $H_0 : \mu_1 = \mu_2 = \mu_3 \dots = \mu_k$
  - $H_A$  : At least two of the group means  $\mu_1, \mu_2, \mu_3, \dots, \mu_k$  are not equal

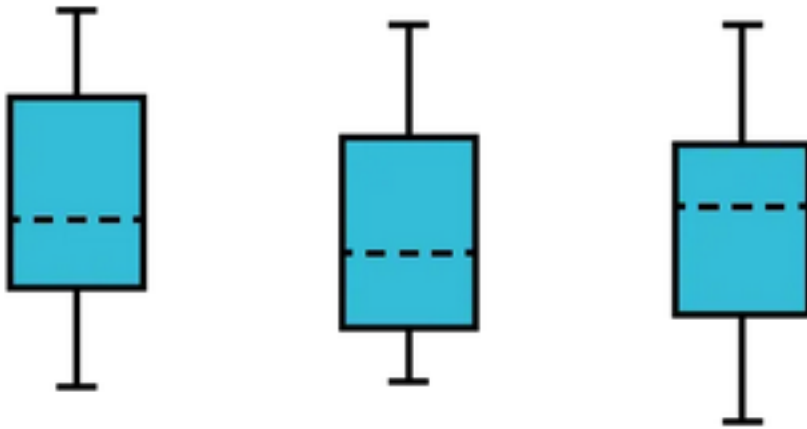
#### ! Important

Be *\*very\** careful in how you phrase the alternative hypothesis for this test, it looks a little bit different than the other tests we've covered before!

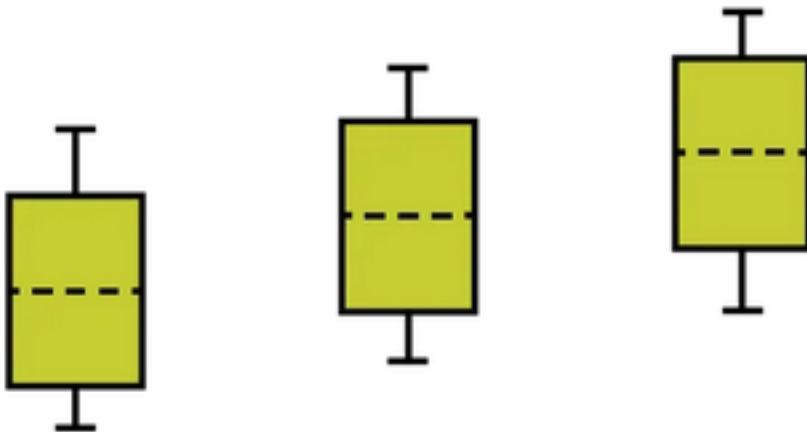
- Effectively, a statistically significant F-statistic only tells us that a difference exists \_\_\_\_\_, but not where that difference lies
  - More explanation on this in the [Extensions](#) section!

 Discuss: What is the name of type of the following plots?





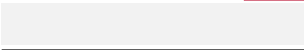
(a)



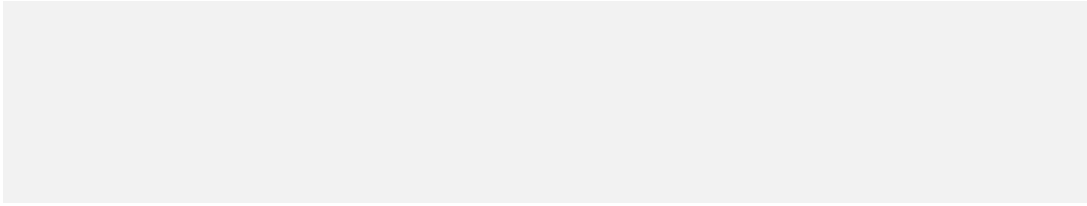
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## 4.4 Extensions

- Of course, this is only the tip of the iceberg
- One question that the ANOVA alone                      answer: which of the groups are different?
  - If we have a                      one-way ANOVA test, then we can follow up with **post-hoc testing**, which can tell us which                      exactly are different than one another

- There is also the **two-way ANOVA**, which allows us to compare two or more  variables and their combined and interacting impact on a single dependent variable in two-way Analysis of Variance.
  - While beyond the scope of this class,  are an incredibly important part of a lot of more complicated studies
- Finally, there is the **repeated-measures ANOVA**

 Discuss: Which of the previous tests we talked about dealt with comparing two sets of measurements, taken at two separate time points, on the same sample?



## 5 Conclusion

### 5.1 Recap

- We can think of a one-way ANOVA as being similar to an independent-samples t-test, but for more than 2 groups. Just note the differences in the null/alternative hypotheses setup
- There are some important extensions and other applications of the ANOVA that we did not comprehensively cover here. However, they do still employ the F-distribution and have the underlying focus on comparing variances to make conclusions about differences between groups
- The F-distribution adds to the other practical distributions employed as part of hypothesis testing, such as the t-distribution and chi-squared distribution. Just like those, it allows us to conclude whether a null hypothesis can be rejected or retained.

## Key Terms

### A

**Analysis of Variance (ANOVA)** A family of statistical tests used to compare variances as a way to detect differences between more than two groups 2

### F

**F-distribution** A distribution developed by Ronald Fisher, expressed as a ratio, used commonly for the ANOVA family of tests 3

**F-ratio** Another name for the F-statistic derived from an ANOVA test, based upon the ratio of the variances between the samples to the variances within the samples 5

### M

**mean square** The computational representation of variation between groups 6

### P

**post-hoc testing** Statistical testing done after a significant ANOVA to tease apart where exactly differences lie between the groups 11

### R

**repeated-measures ANOVA** A type of ANOVA used when measurements are taken on the same sample 3 or more times, to compare against each other at different time points 12

### T

**two-way ANOVA** A type of ANOVA that allows for testing two independent (grouping) variables impact on a single dependent (outcome) variable 12

### V

**Variances between samples** How much differences there are between the 3 or more groups that we are comparing 6

**Variances within samples** How much variances occur within each of the groups we are comparing against one another 6

*The instructor-provided glossary may not include all terms worth memorizing, make sure you consider using the vocabulary list in your book and your own judgment to make sure you have all relevant terms*